

From Data to Deployment:

Interpreting Violent Crime Trends for Operational Decision-Making



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Executive Summary

Violence remains 74% lower than 1990s peak

Knife-enabled offences decreased by 9% in the latest year

Homicide low but high harm

Majority of violence non-injury

Harm-based targeting recommended

Data Context & Scope

Source

- Office for National Statistics (ONS)
- Crime Survey for England & Wales (CSEW)
- Police Recorded Crime (PRC)

CSEW measures victimisation (including unreported crime); while Police Recorded Crime reflects offences reported and recorded by forces.

These sources measure different things and should not be directly compared.

Coverage

- England & Wales
- Year ending September 2025
- Long term analysis (1980s-2025)

Violence Definition

- Violence with injury (wounding, assault)
- Violence without injury
- Knife-enabled and weapon-related offences (PRC)

Data Issues & Limitations



Comparability Over Time

- 2019 repeat victimisation methodology change
- COVID survey suspension (2021–22)
- Recording rule changes (HOCR/NCRS)

Measurement Differences

- CSEW = victimisation survey
- Police recorded crime = reported & recorded offences

Statistical Constraints

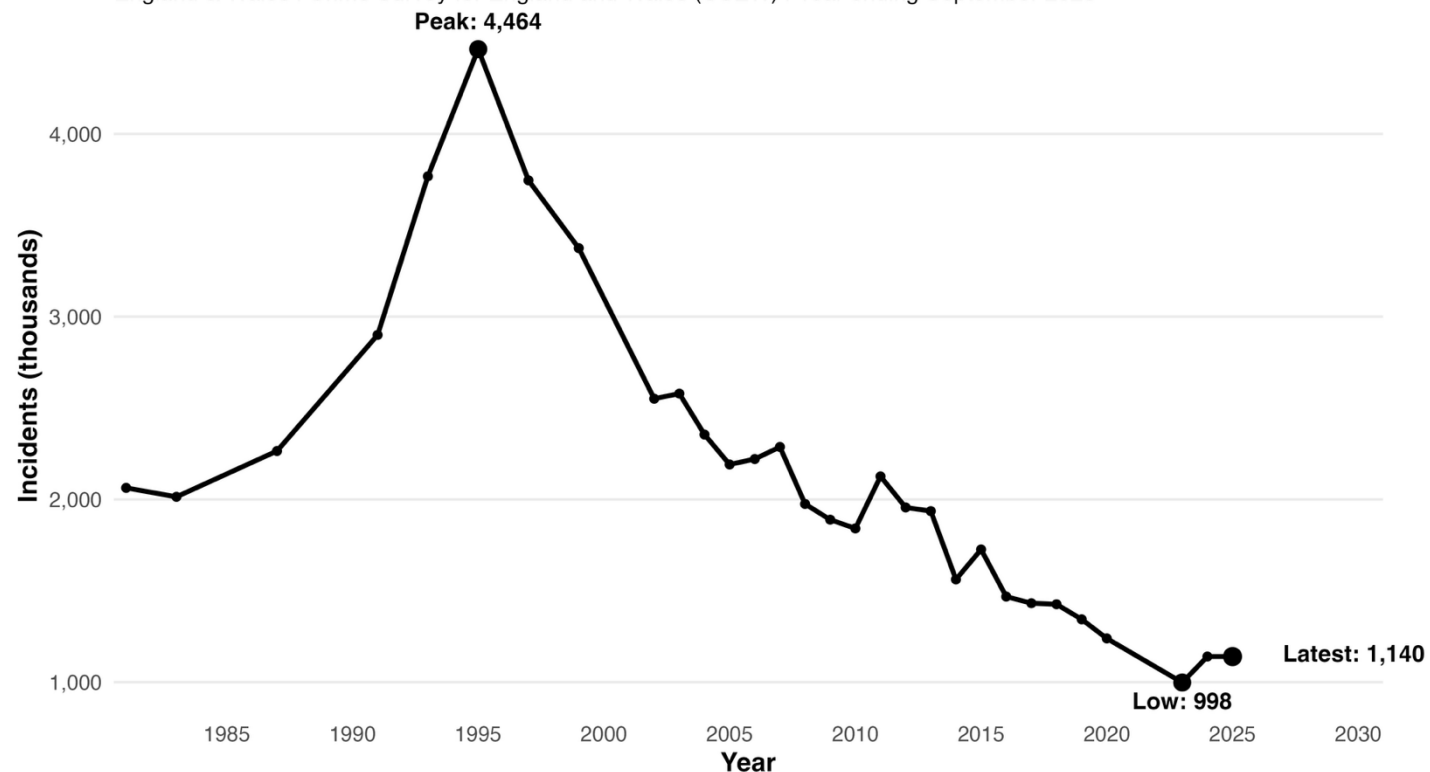
- Smaller survey sample size post-2013
- Volatility in low-frequency offences
- Rounding

Strategic Context

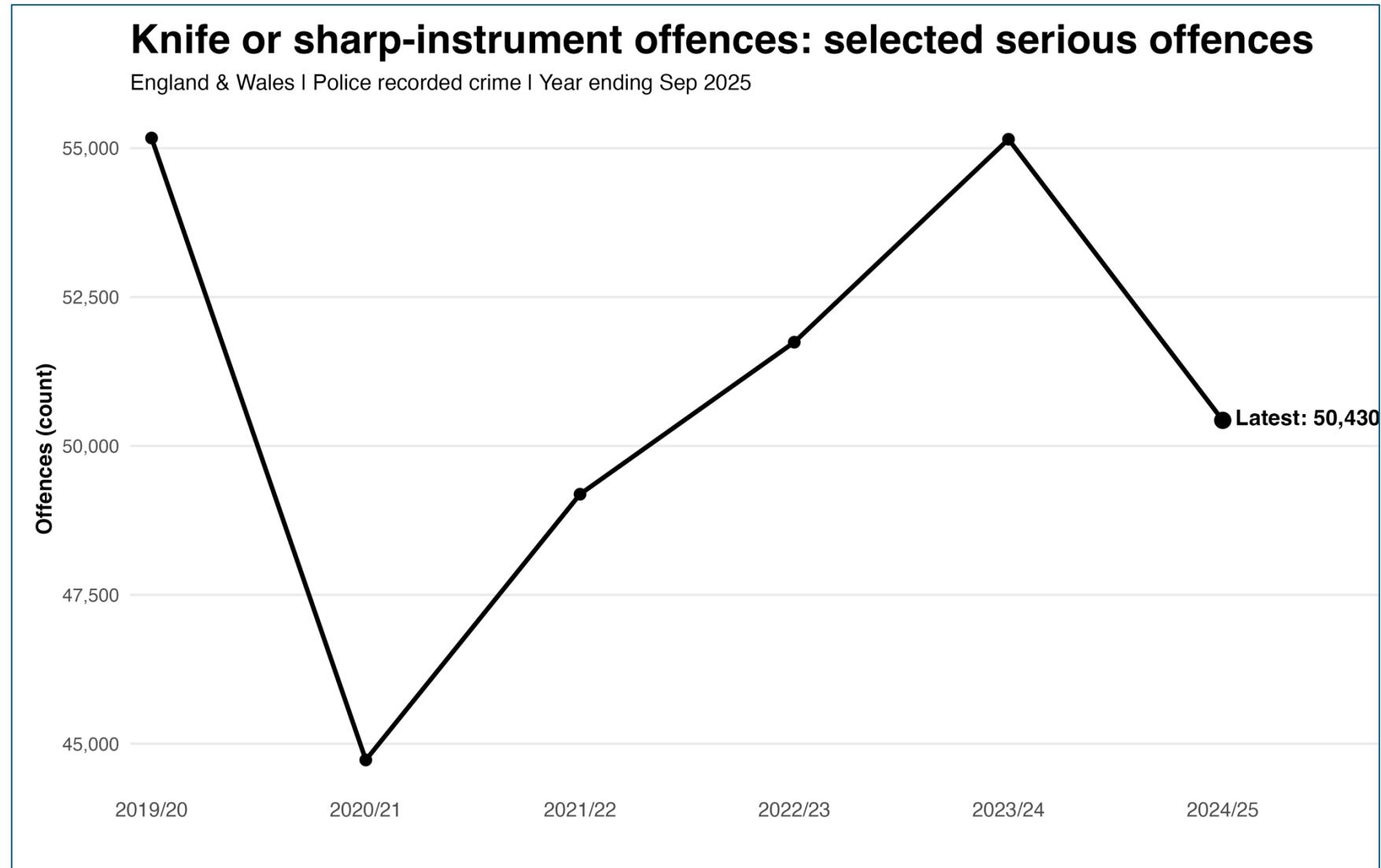
- Violence 74% lower than mid-1990s peak
- Long-term trend shows sustained decline
- Current levels remain historically low despite recent fluctuations

Violence Has Fallen 74% Since the Mid-1990s Peak

England & Wales | Crime Survey for England and Wales (CSEW) | Year ending September 2025



- Knife-enabled offences rise between 2020-2024
- Latest year shows a 9% decrease
- Remains a key high-harm offence monitored through police recorded crime



Operational Implications

- Prioritise weapon-enabled violence and wounding in identified hotspots
- Long-term violence decline suggests strategic prevention has had sustained impact
- However high-harm offences such as knife crime require continuous operational monitoring
- Police recorded crime provides the most timely operational signal
- Data dashboards allow analysts and commanders to monitor emerging risks and allocate resources effectively

Dashboard Design Framework

To support operational decision-making the dashboard should enable:

- Clear separation of survey data (long-term trends) and police recorded crime (operational demand)
- Rapid identification of emerging trends
- Filtering by offence type, harm level and time period
- Clear visual summaries for non-technical users

Crime Analytics Dashboard Prototype

Data source

CSEW

Offence type

Total violence

Total violence

Violence with injury

Violence without injury

Assault with minor injury

Wounding

- Built using **R Shiny** to support interactive exploration of crime trends

- Users can filter by offence type and year range to analyse patterns over time

- KPI indicators highlight total incidents, year-on-year change and long-term trends

